cwm - an enclosed arm-chair-shaped hollow situated at the head of a valley

scrambling - climbing hurriedly on hands and knees

wriggle - to move with a twist or turn

traverse - to cross a mountain slope horizontally or diagonally; the name given to such a crossing

tantalize - tease or taunt

cramponed - climbing on ice wearing spike shoes

1. Based on your reading of the text, answer the following questions in one or two sentences each.

a) What did Hillary do with his wet boots?

b) Name an equipment and a tool carried by the climbers during their expedition.

c) Why did Hillary become clumsy-fingered and slow-moving?

d) What did Hillary find in a tiny hollow?

e) When did Hillary feel a sense of freedom and well being?

f) What did Hillary mean by saying "We had had enough to do the job, but by no means too much"?

2. Answer the following questions in two or three sentences each.

a) How did the mountaineers belay?

b) Why was the original zest fading away?

c) What did Edmund Hillary do to escape the large overhanging ice cornices?

d) What did Tenzing and Edmund Hillary gift to the Gods of lofty Summit? How did they do it?

e) What did the photograph portray?

f) The soft snow was difficult and dangerous. Why?

g) How did the firm snow at the higher regions fill them with hope?

3. Based on the text, answer the following questions in a paragraph in about 100–150 words each.

a) How did Hillary and Tenzing prepare themselves before they set off to the summit? (Para 1, 2 and 3)

b) Give an account of the journey to the South Col from 28,000 feet.(Para 4 to 8)

c) Describe the feelings of Edmund Hillary and Tenzing as they reached the top of the Summit. (Para 18)

d) The ridge had taken us two and half hours, but it seemed like lifetime. Why? (Para 15 to 17)

e) Describe the view from the top. What was the most important photograph? (Para 19 and 20)

f) 'There is no height, no depth that the spirit of man, guided by higher Spirit cannot attain'. Discuss the above statement in the context of the achievement of Edmund Hillary and Tenzing.

DO YOU KNOW?

Indian Mountaineering Foundation (IMF) is the apex national body for mountaineering and allied sports. IMF supports, promotes and regulates national and international climbing and mountaineering in India. IMF is also the regulatory body for the competitive Olympic sport of Sport Climbing. IMF is also engaged in mountain protection work, knowledge building and creating awareness of the Indian Himalaya.

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